In summary, a contract is a JSON object containing consumer and provider interactions, outlining the request details and expected response data, as well as the data setup details and dynamic response data rules.

3.4 What is a contract broker?

Where do the contracts get stored? Sharing the contracts between repositories and potentially different repository providers means there needs to be a central place to store the contracts. A *broker* is “a person who talks to opposing sides, especially governments, making arrangements for them or bringing disagreements to an end” (https://mng.bz/BgjJ).

Without a broker, passing around contracts can be tricky because of the different versions caused by code changes. Even if the contracts live in source control, a workflow must be active to notify other teams of updates, and there should also be a consistent storage structure.

Using the Pact Broker as an example, its purpose isn’t to arrange but to organize and facilitate the contract life cycle, facilitating the sharing process of contracts among multiple software development teams. The broker builds the network of connections between teams and different data requirements from each other. In a CDCT approach, the consumer pushes their contract containing the version and other metadata up to the broker. The metadata allows the provider to pull down the contract version they need to verify. As shown in figure 3.3, the broker holds the information about the different consumers and providers, such as when the latest contract was published, webhook status, and when the provider last verified the contract.